**Shared Drives: Access Issues**

Users may experience problems accessing shared drives due to network, permission, or authentication issues. The following steps can help identify and resolve common problems.

**Common Access Issues**

| Issue | Possible Cause | Resolution |
|---|---|---|
| **Access Denied** | Insufficient Share or NTFS permissions | Verify the user's permissions and group membership. |
| **Network Path Not Found** | Incorrect server or shared folder path | Check the UNC path (e.g., \\ServerName\SharedFolder) and ensure the server is online. |
| **Drive Not Accessible** | Network or VPN disconnected | Connect to the local network or VPN and try again. |
| **Credential Prompt Reappears** | Incorrect or expired credentials | Remove saved credentials and sign in with the correct account. |
| **Mapped Drive Missing** | Drive was disconnected or mapping removed | Remap the network drive and enable **Reconnect at sign-in**. |

**Troubleshooting Steps**

**1. Check Network Connectivity**

- Ensure the computer is connected to the network or VPN.
- Verify the file server is reachable by opening:

\\ServerName

- Test connectivity using Command Prompt:

ping ServerName

**2. Verify the Shared Folder Path**

- Confirm the network path is correct:

\\ServerName\SharedFolder

- Check for spelling mistakes in the server or share name.

**3. Check User Permissions**

- Verify the user has the required **Share** and **NTFS** permissions.
- Confirm the user belongs to the appropriate security group.
- Remember that the most restrictive permission applies.

**4. Clear Saved Credentials**

1. Open **Control Panel** > **Credential Manager**.
2. Remove saved credentials for the file server.
3. Reconnect to the shared drive using the correct username and password.

**5. Remap the Network Drive**

If the mapped drive is unavailable:

1. Open **File Explorer**.
2. Select **This PC** > **Map network drive**.
3. Enter the correct shared folder path.
4. Select **Reconnect at sign-in**.
5. Complete the connection.

**6. Restart the Computer**

A restart can resolve temporary network or authentication issues.

**Best Practices**

- Use security groups to manage permissions instead of assigning access to individual users.
- Keep drive mappings consistent across users.
- Ensure VPN is connected before accessing company shared drives remotely.
- Regularly review and update permissions to maintain secure access.

Following these steps resolves most shared drive access issues. If the problem persists, verify that the file server is operational and consult your IT administrator for further assistance.